

Elegant Night Journey

With Stories

— ✦ —
A Journey full of precious moments
and emotions which overtime
became my memory.



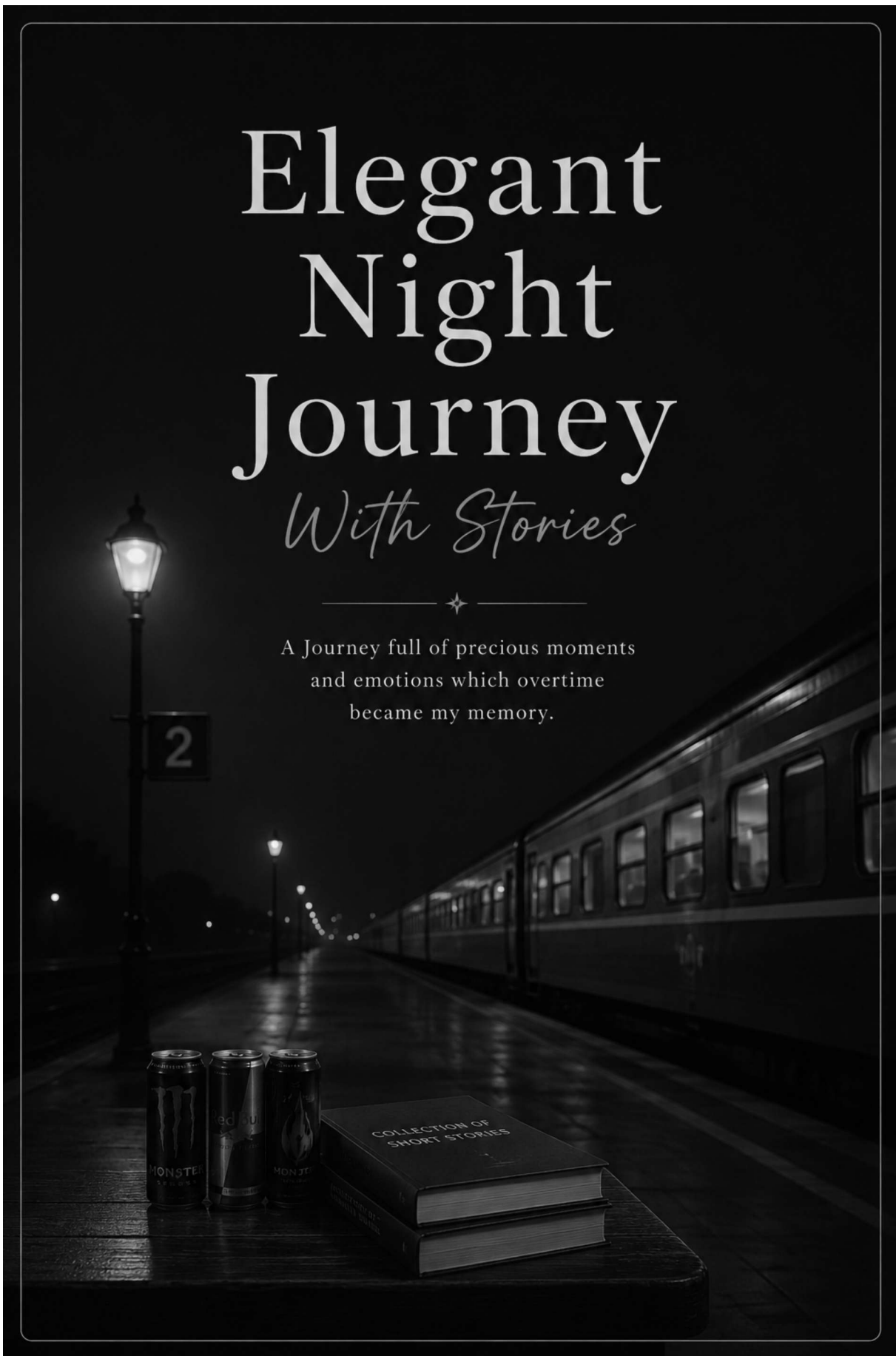
By - Afdob
Jun 10, 2026

To remember the great time with Lapis Q.

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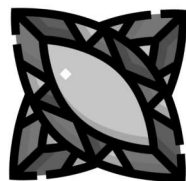
Life Flows

Life Flows is a slice of life collection by Afdob in which he shared dozens of short stories which aligns the flow of life with growing age and moving time.

Life Flows has various standalone pieces like: Going out with anxiety, My first secret at Kanpur, My Second Secret at Kanpur, To Take Care at Delhi, About a week at Mussoorie, The beginning of my year 22 and many more.

Most of the pieces written in life flows moves around the main protagonist 'Lapis Lazuli' and writer himself.

All pieces written in the life flows are dedicated to Lapis Lazuli only.



I have accepted you every second but you never joyed the day with me. I wanted to live in this delusion forever if you are the one meant for me.

- Afdob

I will always remember that journey with you on a car, on a train, on a bus or hand on hand, it all flashes before my eyes before a good night sleep everyday.

ELEGANT NIGHT JOURNEY WITH STORIES

-By Afdob

PART - I

(A Night At Station)

I was a college student back in 2026, in the electronics engineering department. In a program of eight semesters, seven of mine were completed and it was my last semester. It was the time when most of my friends, classmates, and batch mates had already left the hostel long ago, but I stayed—not because I wanted to, but because of a girl I liked the most in my life. She was none other than my very own girlfriend. Her name was Lapis, Lapis Lazuli—for me, she was Lapis Queen, or in short, Lapis Q.

Lapis was a fair-skinned girl. Whoever saw her with their own eyes would certainly fall for her. After looking at her for the first time, I felt nothing, and that's because she was way out of my league—way better than someone like me. I would say it was not love at first sight, neither for me nor for her, but it was a slow-paced love. We have been dating since Jan 01, 2026—such a perfect day, isn't it? I remember correctly, I asked her out on a date on Jan 01, 2026, just so that it would sync perfectly. It would be cool if I asked her on New Year's, but I guess she barely gave a thought to that. Well, it's fine since she said yes. I think I can keep writing about her as long as I live, so let's keep her and her stories for some other time, but yeah, I know one thing: I still love her a lot.

Since most of my friends and other hostlers are gone, I feel lonely in my college most of the time, so I usually talk with Lapis on phone calls for most of the day. Why most of the day? It's because her evening hours were busy; I don't know why, but she avoided talking during that time. But still, for

most of the day and entire nights, we kept on calls. Since it was my first relationship, it was very precious to me—whatever was happening was my first experience. I was always very excited to talk to her; irrespective of my situation, I always picked up her calls anyway.

It was Jan 18, 2026. I was very excited as I would be returning to my college from home after a long leave of a straight 15 days. I was very excited because now I could talk to her anytime with no time boundaries, and we could go for lunch or shopping sometime. Yes, I was way too eager.

My college was around 320 km away from my hometown. To reach my college, I had to go to the railway station, which was around a 10 to 15-minute distance from my home. Then the train would take around 7 to 8 hours, after which I needed to travel by bus for an hour to reach my college. This whole journey always took my entire day, but this time I choose a night journey so that I could save my daytime.

I already had my train reservation; my coach and seat were B3/63/Side Lower. It was a 3rd AC coach and my train's arrival time was around 10:15 in the night. I had already done my packing during the daytime and was ready to depart from my home.

I left my home around 9:50 PM to be on the safe side and reached the station by 10:00 PM. With me, I had three energy drinks, two large chocolates, and some other snacks. After reaching the station, I checked my train's location and it was way behind schedule—it was late by more than an hour, which is supposed to be normal in India. Now I had nothing to do, so I started walking along the platform and checking the trains' timing and status on the station screens.

That's when I realized that my train, which was supposed to arrive on platform number 3, would now be coming on platform number 2, and after seeing that, I moved forward.

Entering the platform, I saw very few people were around, but most of the shops were open. I walked up to a shop and asked the shopkeeper, "Sir, do you have a water bottle?"

He reached his hand below his counter, took out a water bottle, and put it on the counter where I was standing without saying anything. He was an old man, seeming like he was 55 years or older. Since he was keeping his silence, I thought he was chewing tobacco or something, but I wasn't there to talk with him; I just wanted some supplies, that's all. Then I thought it was going to be a long journey, so I should take some snacks as well, and so I bought two packets of namkeen. While doing that, I kept looking at his book and magazine section. Suddenly, a few books piqued my interest, and I asked, "Sir, how much for this one?"

He Said - It's 320.

His words was clear and pronunciation was accurate so he wasn't chewing anything.

I was well aware of the writer and curiously asked, "Do you have any others from the same author?" He handed me many other books by the same author. I took the books, and since they were all short stories, I looked at their indexes to check if any title piqued my interest. I started talking to him about the author, other writers, and their books. Surprisingly, he suddenly became interested and started talking and showing me many books, among which I bought two that would help me kill time at the station. After

making the payment, I moved along and found a perfect, empty bench to sit on. I put my bag down and sat there comfortably beside it, after checking my train's location, which still showed around 40 to 50 minutes until arrival.

I opened my bag, took out an energy drink, opened the can, and took a sip. It was refreshing, so I opened the newly bought book and started reading it. The book was "First Loves, Last Loves," a collection of short stories by Ruskin Bond.

On a railway station platform at midnight, on platform number 2 where only a few people could be seen sitting far away from me or on the other platforms, the temperature was around 26 degrees Celsius. It was a perfect temperature, and I was sitting on a bench all alone, taking small sips of an energy drink while reading my book. If I remember correctly, whoever passed by gave me a strange look—maybe because nobody expected a 21-year-old boy to be reading a hardcover book while waiting for his train in 2026. It was a digital era.

In between my first story, a boy came across my bench, looked around, and sat beside me; maybe he thought it was safe to sit here. At a certain point, a thought crossed my mind—it might be possible he was a thief or a pickpocket. But looking at him, it felt more like he was a student himself, much more nervous than I was. He was holding his bag in his lap while sitting on the seat. His formal dress-up and well-mannered posture made it seem like he must be a working professional or a graduate student. His shirt color was purple with cream-colored formal pants, dark black formal shoes, and a mid-dark brown leather belt that matched his pants. His hair was black and well-combed; at

a certain point, I even admired his hairstyle. I was still busy reading my story and enjoying my drink. He was just sitting beside me; we never talked. Neither he nor I initiated the conversation. He waited there for around 20 minutes before picking up his bag and moving to the left of the platform. He was gone; slowly and slowly, he moved further and further away, and vanished on the platform.

After some time, a beggar came to me. At first, I didn't get what he was trying to say, but after putting in some effort, I understood he was asking for my energy drink. It was a Red Bull can and I was drinking from it, so I said, "Sorry sir, but I have been drinking from this can. I can't give you this." After saying that, I realized that he was drunk, so I knew I had to ignore him from then on. So I did, and he left the place.

I kept up my reading and completed many stories, and drank three cans of energy drink. Now I was out of energy drinks, and I was already fed up with the stories; I didn't want to read anymore.

Since I had nothing to do, I took out my phone, opened it, and sent a "Sup!" to Lapis Q. As always, she responded immediately and we talked for some time, but due to some constraints, she said she needed to go and said good night. It was way too early compared to other days, but she was sleepy anyway.

After spending some time, I realized that the crowd on the station had been growing—is it a good sign? Maybe, yes. So, I took out my phone again and checked the train; it was very near. I looked at the coach position screens, and B3 was exactly at the point where I was sitting, so I kept my cool

and stayed on my bench there, waiting for the train.

The platform was still very empty; no more than 10 people were to be seen. Maybe because it was night, there was no rush, no noise, nothing—it was a very calm and silent platform. Suddenly, a brightly illuminated light beam appeared from far away. I was still at my bench, knowing the fact that it would be a 5-minute stop for the train. With heavy vibrations and an intense sound, a green locomotive passed me slowly, and so I stood up and picked up my bag and book.

I boarded my coach, and when I entered, it was dark; other passengers were sleeping. So, without making any noise, I lay down on my seat. It was a cool coach, so I grabbed my blanket and made a comfortable bed for myself.

The coach was dark, so reading a book was out of the question, but I had options. This time, I took out my earphones and smartphone and started my traveling playlist. With the night view outside the window, the low temperature, music in my ears, and Lapis Queen on my mind, it was a perfect moment for someone like me.

The lights from afar were illuminating, and the train was moving fast in silence. Outside the window, as far as I could see, were long empty fields, trees, farms, and greenery, which were dark at the time. I could never imagine going to a place like that during midnight, but I was feeling very safe inside the train.

With low music, a night view and lapis queen in my mind i slowly closed my eyes and fell asleep.

END OF PART - I

(A Night At Station)